



FREE RESOURCE - FIRST-TIME SITTERS

A CLEAR, PHASE-BY-PHASE PLAN FOR FIRST-TIME SITTERS

The March 2027 GAMSAT S1 & S2 Game Plan

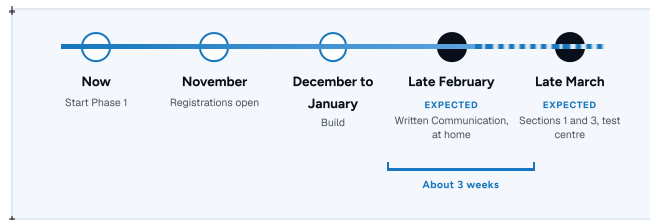
WHAT'S IN HERE

- 01 Why March 2027 is really two exam days, and why that changes when your essays need to be ready
- 02 The four phases, with how many hours a week each one needs
- 03 The frameworks I teach for each phase
- 04 A quick check at the end, with what to do next for anything you can't tick



THE TIMELINE

The March 2027 sitting is split across two test days, three weeks apart



So what does that actually change?

01

S2 needs to *peak* first.

If you're working towards March, you'll be about three weeks late for S2. The essay work starts **now**. Better essays come from writing regularly and getting them marked, so you know what to fix next.

02

You're sitting the essays from home.

Sounds easier, right? Not necessarily. It's your space, your desk and your distractions. Do your February practice at home, in conditions as close to the real thing as you can get, so exam day doesn't feel new.

03

The three weeks in between matter.

That's when Sections 1 and 3 get your full attention. Plan it properly now so you can spend the majority of February on S2.



One quick admin thing: registrations usually open in November. Chuck a reminder in your calendar today.

OVERVIEW

The plan at a glance

Four phases, two peaks. For Sections 1 and 2, I'd start at 8 to 10 hours a week and build up to 10 to 15 as you get closer to the exam. It's about doing the **right things** at the **right time**.

PHASE · WHEN · HOURS	SECTION 1	SECTION 2	CHECKPOINT
PHASE 1 Foundations Late September to November 8 to 10 hrs / week	Learn how the questions actually work. Start a mistake log.	Learn what analysis looks like. 1 to 2 essays a week, untimed is fine.	● Get an essay marked against a clear standard
PHASE 2 Build December to January 10+ hrs / week	Timed mixed sets, with a time budget for each text type	Build your Common Thread Bank. A timed essay every week.	● Your mistake log starts to show your top 3 mistake patterns so you know <i>exactly</i> what to study for high-yield results.
PHASE 3 Section 2 Season 1 February till S2 exam 10 to 15 hrs / week	At least 15 to 20 questions a week to maintain momentum.	Full timed Task A and Task B sets in exam conditions. Aim for one each week; two if your schedule allows.	● One full timed pair marked before the sitting.
PHASE 4 Section 1 peak Day after S2 until the day of S1/S3 10 to 15 hrs / week	Targeted practice on whatever's costing you marks	Done. Nice work.	● Your weakest text types are improving on your tracker

● **Red dot:** external feedback recommended
 ● **Blue dot:** self-assessment checkpoint

A quick word on Section 3

This plan is mainly about Sections 1 and 2, because that's where most first-time sitters feel least sure about how to study. If you're sitting Section 3 as well, plan that time on top of the hours above. It's on the same test centre day as Section 1, so it peaks in Phase 4 too. Use Phases 1 and 2 to go back over any science foundations you're rusty on before you start leaning on timed questions.

PHASES 1 AND 2

Late September to January: getting the foundations right

These months kind of decide whether February feels calm or chaotic. There are **two** things I want you to come out of them with: **a review habit** that actually changes how you answer S1 questions, and a clear sense of **what a high-scoring evaluative S2 essay looks like** before you start timing yourself.

What a Phase 1 week could look like

ABOUT 9 HOURS

S1 - 90 MIN Do a set, then review it properly	S2 - 90 MIN An essay, or rewriting a paragraph	S1 - 90 MIN Do a set, then review it properly	S2 - 90 MIN An essay, or rewriting a paragraph	S1 - 90 MIN Do a set, then review it properly	REVIEW DAY Log your mistakes and reflect on where to improve.	DAY OFF Reset and recharge. This is a marathon and you need to pace yourself.
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How to review your Section 1 questions

Most students review by reading the explanation, thinking "yep, that makes sense", and moving on. Then the next week they make the same mistake... sound familiar? This is the habit that stops the same mistakes coming back. So after every wrong answer:

- 1 Work out the specific mistake you made.
- 2 Give the pattern a name. *"I fell for the half-comment trap."*
- 3 Write one sentence on what you'll do differently. *"Next time, I'll count the claims in the target comment."*
- 4 Do another question of the same type straight away.

It adds a minute or two per question. Keep it all in a mistake log, and by December your top three patterns should be pretty obvious. **Then**, when you know where your mistakes are, you can do **targeted practice** on your specific weak areas.

How to schedule your Section 2 essays

Aim to write 1 to 2 essays each week, ideally a Task A and Task B. Task A and Task B reward different approaches, so practise both **consistently**. The focus for these first few months is:

- 1 Getting comfortable with your essay structure
- 2 Learning how to come up with essay ideas *regardless* of the prompts
- 3 Improving the quality of analysis and examples in your writing
- 4 Getting feedback from a friend, peer or tutor to figure out what needs fixing.

PHASES 1 AND 2, CONTINUED

S1: give each text type a time budget

If you're spending 2 minutes per mark on a short poem and 2 minutes per mark on a 50-line fiction passage, that's usually a sign of inefficient time allocation. As you practise, you'll start to note which text types require *more* time and which you can move through *quicker*. As a rule of thumb, aim for roughly 1 to 1.5 minutes per mark for cartoons, short poems and comments and allocate 1.5 to 3 minutes per mark for long passages. *Be efficient.*

Short texts

Poems, comments, cartoons

1 to 1.5

MIN PER MARK

Long texts

Long prose, technical texts

1.5 to 3

MIN PER MARK

STUDENT RESULT

+9 points in Section 1

Hey Rohan hope you're well too!
I scored 9 point better in S1! Thank you for your help. 😊

S2: from observation to analysis

An **observation** tells the marker what happens. **Analysis** tells them why it happens, how it happens, or why it matters.

OBSERVATION Social media makes people lonely.

ANALYSIS Social media can intensify loneliness because it creates the illusion of connection while replacing slower, more vulnerable forms of real-world intimacy.

If you're stuck in a paragraph, ask yourself: why does this happen? What does it lead to? Why should anyone care? It pushes you past describing and into analysis.

What happens gives you a starting point. Exploring why it happens gives your essay depth.

Where self-study breaks down

Look, you can do most of this plan on your own. The checkpoints are the exception. Self-review helps, but outside feedback often reveals weaknesses you can no longer see. So work out now *who's* going to look at your work at each red dot.

PHASES 3 AND 4

February to March: two peaks

The Common Thread Bank

Avoid memorising complete essays. They often become rigid when the prompt changes.

Build a handful of **idea chains** instead, ones you can carry into lots of different prompts:



For example: social media → constant comparison → anxiety and dissatisfaction → essays on identity, youth, mental health, authenticity. (1 idea chain; countless potential essays)

SECTION 2 RESULT

50 → 81

Understanding what examiners want, developing ideas and learning how to structure them.

Hey Rohan! How did your GAMSAT in September go?

Hey Rohan, I got an 81 in Section 2, a tremendous jump from 50 in my previous sitting. Your teachings about what examiners want, ideas and how to structure helped tremendously which is why I saw a huge jump. Thanks Man!

⚠ Watch out for the force-fit

If your essay could answer pretty much any quote set on that topic, it wasn't written for this one, and the marker can tell. Your threads are raw material, not a script. Start from what's specific about the prompt in front of you and build out from there.

Targeted prep: the final three weeks

In the three weeks before the test centre sitting, unstructured practice is rarely the best use of limited time.

Don't default to practising what you're already good at. Practise what's costing you marks.

And don't burn out. You want to peak on exam day, not the week before it.

- 1 Go through your question tracker and find the text types and skills where your accuracy is lowest.
- 2 For each one, ask how often it actually comes up in the exam, and which section is highest yield for you. Prioritise the weak areas that come up a lot.
- 3 Put most of your time there, but don't drop your stronger areas completely. A lighter touch keeps them sharp.
- 4 Do 5 to 10 questions per priority area, and write out your reasoning for every option.
- 5 Review the ones you got wrong for patterns, then go again.

CHECK YOUR PLAN

Where are you starting from?

Tick what's true for you right now. Anything you can't tick yet isn't a problem. It just tells you what to do next.

RIGHT NOW	IF YOU CAN'T TICK IT YET, DO THIS NEXT
☐ I can name my top 3 Section 1 mistake patterns.	Do one timed set this week and run every wrong answer through the 4-step review on page 4.
☐ I've had an essay marked against a clear standard recently.	Write one baseline essay now, untimed is fine, and organise who'll mark it.
☐ I know how many hours a week I can realistically keep up until March.	Block out your first Phase 1 week in your calendar using the sample week on page 4.
☐ I've got a review routine that's more than reading the explanation.	Start your mistake log today with the next question you get wrong.
☐ I know who's going to check my work at each checkpoint.	Decide that before your first red dot in November.

Not sure which path fits your plan?

Take the two-minute quiz to see which level of support best fits your current preparation, timeline and need for feedback.

[Take the 2-minute quiz](#)

FROM GAMSAT PREP TO AN OFFER

GAMSAT 75 · up 6 points

USYD DMD offer

Individual results vary.

Hi Rohan, hope you're well. Just wanted to let you know that I was able to score a 75 (6 marks up from last time) for the gamsat and wanted to thank you for all your help for the past lessons. It has helped me tremendously not only in terms of improving my marks, but I feel that I've learned a lot. I got an offer for dmd at usyd and will be starting next year. Thank you again and all the best!

Want the checkpoints built in?

The red dots are the points where outside feedback can be most useful. The Live Comprehensive Course is 24 live classes over 12 weeks (12 for Section 1, 12 for Section 2), starting late October, and you get 6 essays marked along the way, one a fortnight. That covers Phases 1 and 2 of this plan, with me teaching every class.

[See the Comprehensive Course](#)


Talk soon,
Rohan